USING DASHES: THE EDITOR'S ROOM

SUMMARY

- An em dash creates a strong break.
- Use two em dashes around an inserted detail.
- Use one em dash before a final explanation.
- Choose punctuation to shape emphasis.



SEMANTIC MAP



EXAMPLES

- The robotics team—led by Elena—tested its design.
- The team needed one final part—a sensor.



EXERCISES

1. Add paired em dashes:
   The volunteers students from three grades fixed the lamps.
   _____

2. Add one em dash:
   They needed one thing above all patience.
   _____

3. Explain how the tone changes:
   The robotics team, led by Elena, tested its design.
   versus the dash version. _____
   _____

CHALLENGE

Write a 60–80-word news paragraph about a surprising school event. Use a paired insertion and a final explanation with dashes.

_____

_____

_____